

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 932

By Faison

A RESOLUTION to honor and recognize the contributions of
Prison Fellowship.

WHEREAS, the First Amendment to the United States Constitution guarantees the free exercise of religion, and these protections do not end at the prison gate; and

WHEREAS, faith practice in correctional settings fosters personal accountability, improved mental health, and successful reentry into society, thereby promoting safer prisons and reducing recidivism; and

WHEREAS, Prison Fellowship, founded in 1976 by the late Charles Colson following his personal conversion and strengthened faith during his incarceration, has championed the religious liberty of incarcerated individuals and actively supported the adoption and defense of the Religious Land Use and Institutionalized Persons Act of 2000; and

WHEREAS, Prison Fellowship is the nation's largest Christian nonprofit serving prisoners, former prisoners, and their families, annually reaching more than 600,000 individuals and supported by more than 200,000 volunteers nationwide; and

WHEREAS, evaluations of Prison Fellowship's Academy program by the Texas Department of Criminal Justice, Baylor University, and the Minnesota Department of Corrections have shown significant reductions in recidivism—over sixty percent of program participants—demonstrating the power of faith-informed programming to transform lives; and

WHEREAS, Prison Fellowship currently operates its Prison Fellowship Grow program at the Debra K. Johnson Rehabilitation Center to nurture communities where women behind bars can explore and practice human flourishing within the framework of the Christian story; and

WHEREAS, Prison Fellowship currently serves children with an incarcerated parent each year through partnering with local churches to provide Angel Tree gifts at Christmas, including serving 4,488 children in 2024; and

WHEREAS, Prison Fellowship will mark its fiftieth anniversary in 2026, continuing its mission to seek justice, love, mercy, restore hope for men and women behind bars and ensure robust opportunities for religious practice within prisons; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor Prison Fellowship on the occasion of its fiftieth anniversary and commend its decades of service in advancing restoration, rehabilitation, and second chances through faith-based programs.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.